Process Journal

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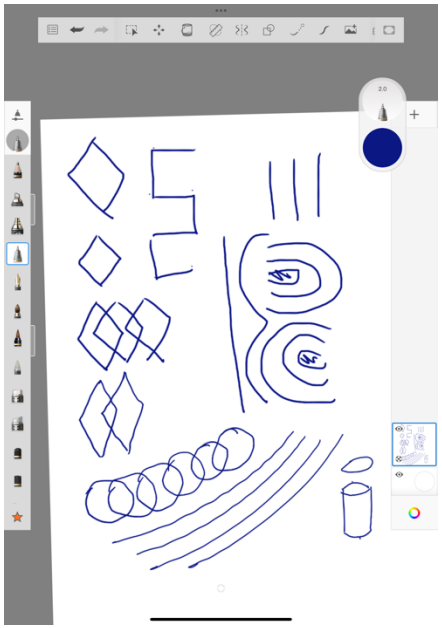
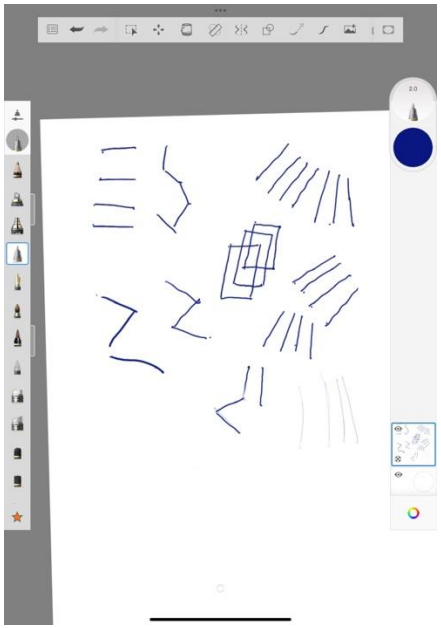
ACR101 Assessment 3

18 February 2025 - Week 1

Warm-up exercises

Warm-up exercises are important because they prepare the body and mind for physical activity. They increase blood flow, loosen muscles, reduce the risk of injury, and improve focus and coordination, helping participants perform better and more safely during the main activity.





At first, I saw warm-ups as just technical drills, but over time I began to use them to reset my mind and prepare creatively for each task.

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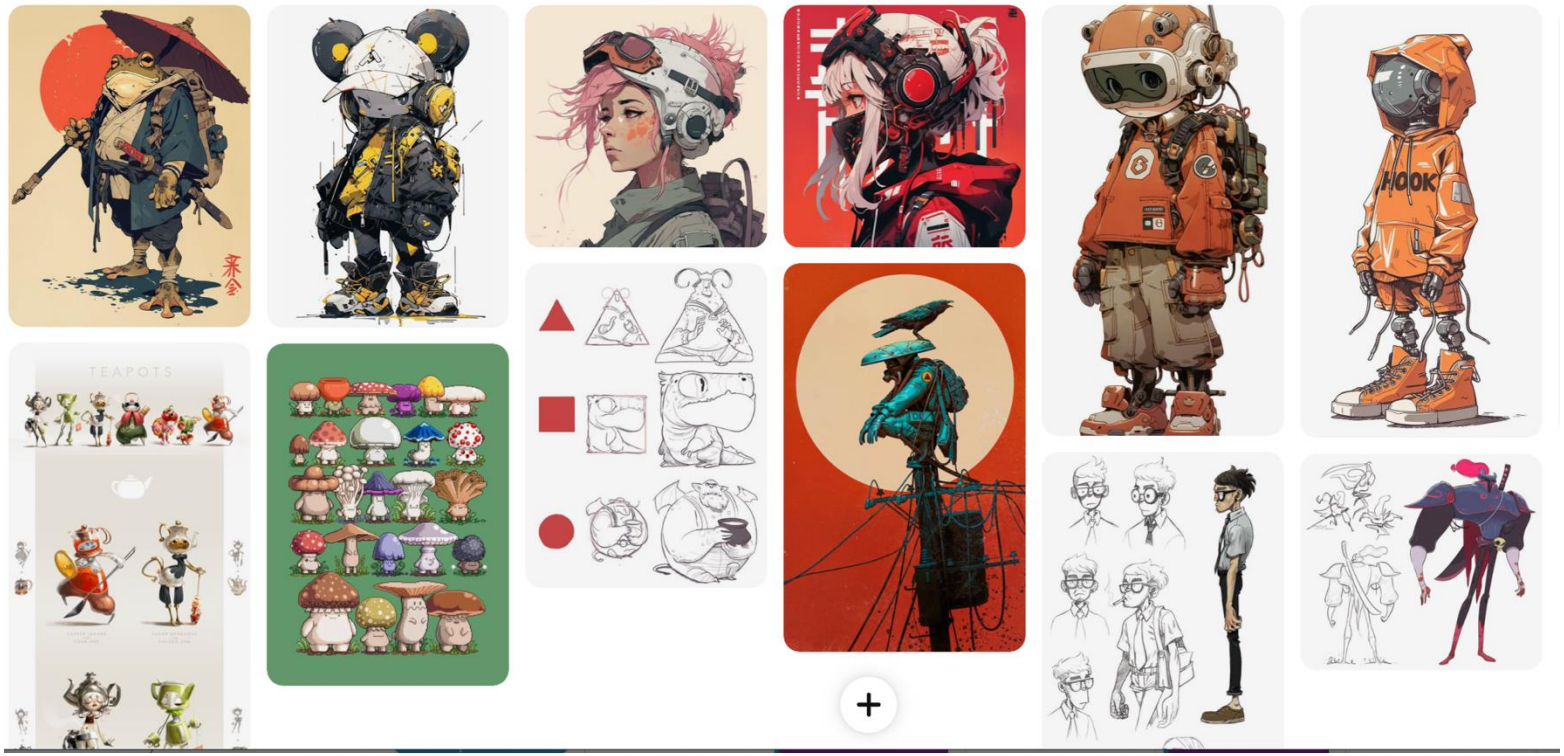
18 February 2025 - Week 1

2D Inspiration - Character Design

A **mood board** is important because it visually communicates the overall tone, style, and direction of a project. It helps align ideas, inspire creativity, and ensure consistency across design elements by gathering references like colors, textures, images, and typography in one place.



In the beginning, I chose images I liked. Later, I started thinking about how color, texture, and emotion could work together to define a visual tone.

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25 February 2025 - Week 2

Silhouette Exercise

The importance of the silhouette exercise lies in training the eye to observe shape, proportion, and negative space without relying on interior details. By drawing the silhouette from observation—rather than tracing—it strengthens perception, simplifies complex forms, and improves overall figure drawing skills.

Initially, I focused on copying shape, but I learned to observe weight and balance — and how silhouettes affect character readability.

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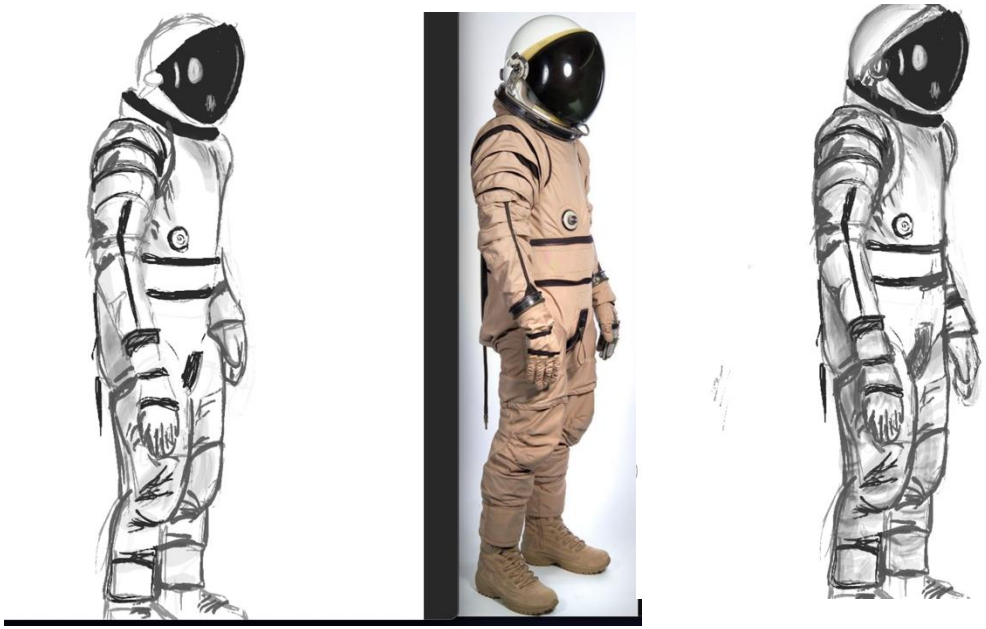
3 March 2025 - Week 3

Reference drawing

Reference drawing is important because it helps artists develop accuracy, proportion, and realism by studying real-life subjects or images. Using references trains the eye to observe details like anatomy, light, texture, and perspective, which builds a stronger foundation for both realistic and stylized artwork.

Astronaut drawing, no ref:

Astronaut redraw, with ref:



I used to draw from imagination without thinking. This taught me the value of observation and how real references improve structure and clarity.

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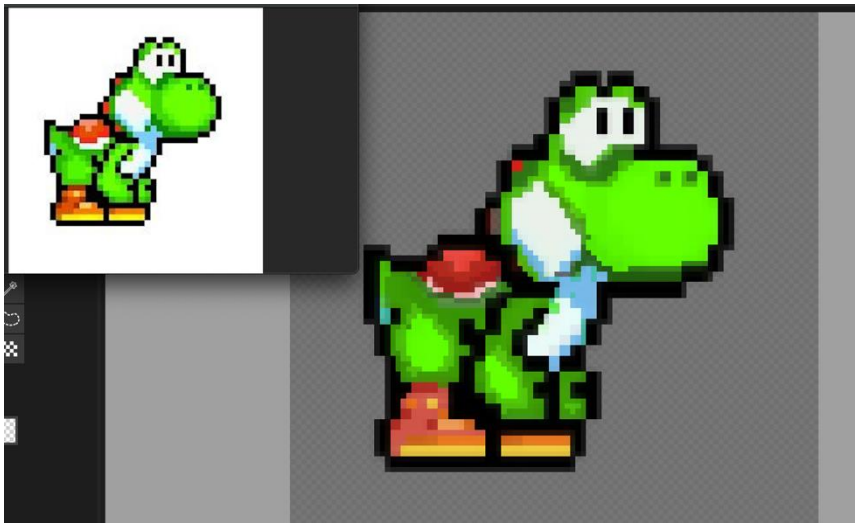
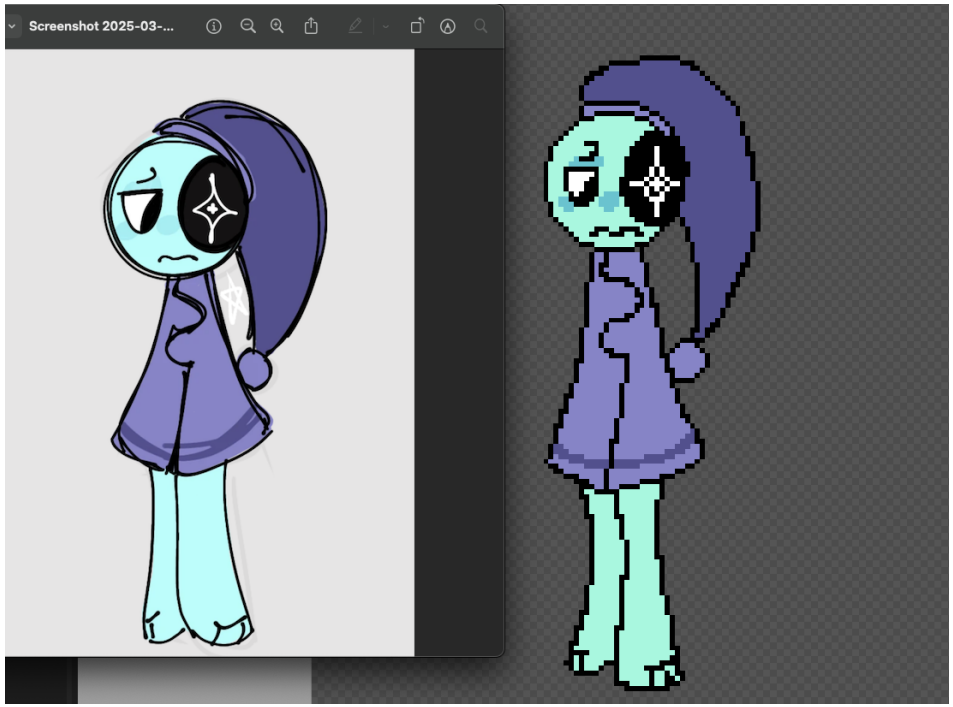
11 March 2025 - Week 4

Pixel Week Exercises

Master copy in Pixel Week Exercises involves recreating existing pixel art from professional games or artists. This practice is important because it helps students understand key principles of pixel design—such as color limitation, shading, proportion, and clarity at low resolutions. By copying a master, students learn industry techniques and develop a sharper eye for detail, which supports the creation of their own original pixel art later.



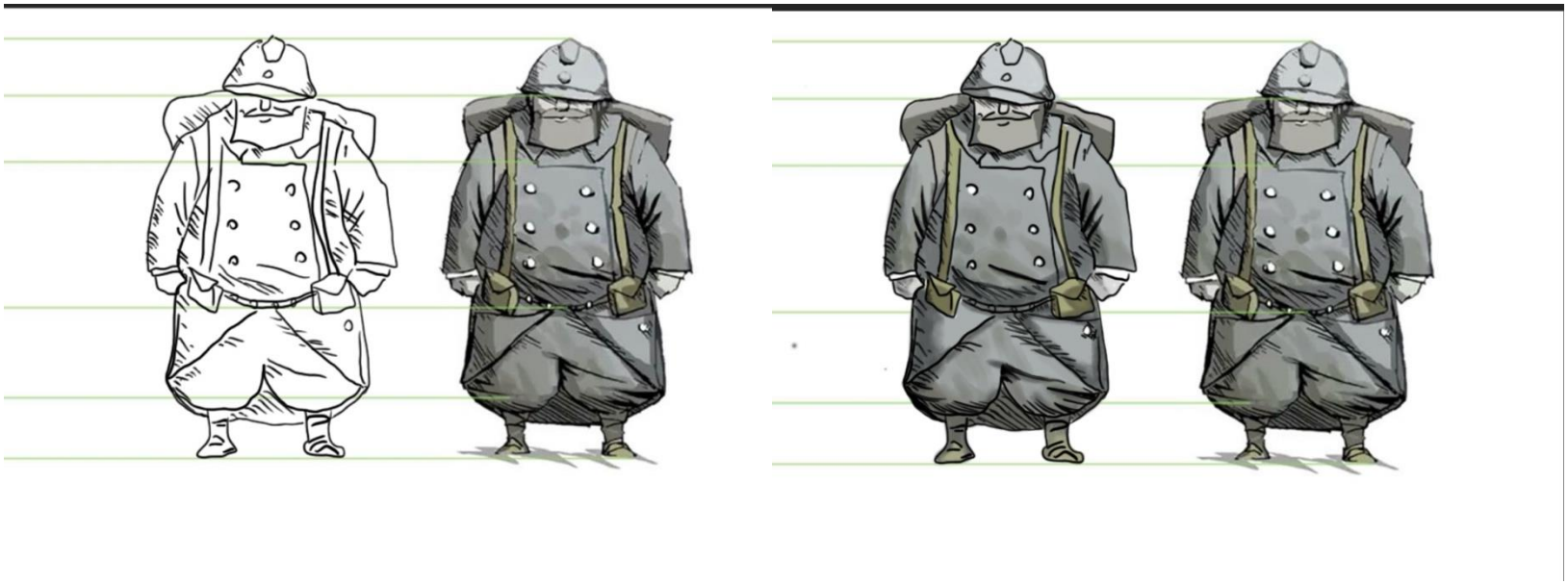


Kira Zakirov

21 March 2025 - Week 5

Warm-up exercises

Master copy is a drawing or painting exercise where an artist recreates a work by a master artist. Its importance lies in learning by imitation — studying composition, technique, line quality, and color choices directly from a professional source. This helps improve technical skill, artistic understanding, and personal style development.



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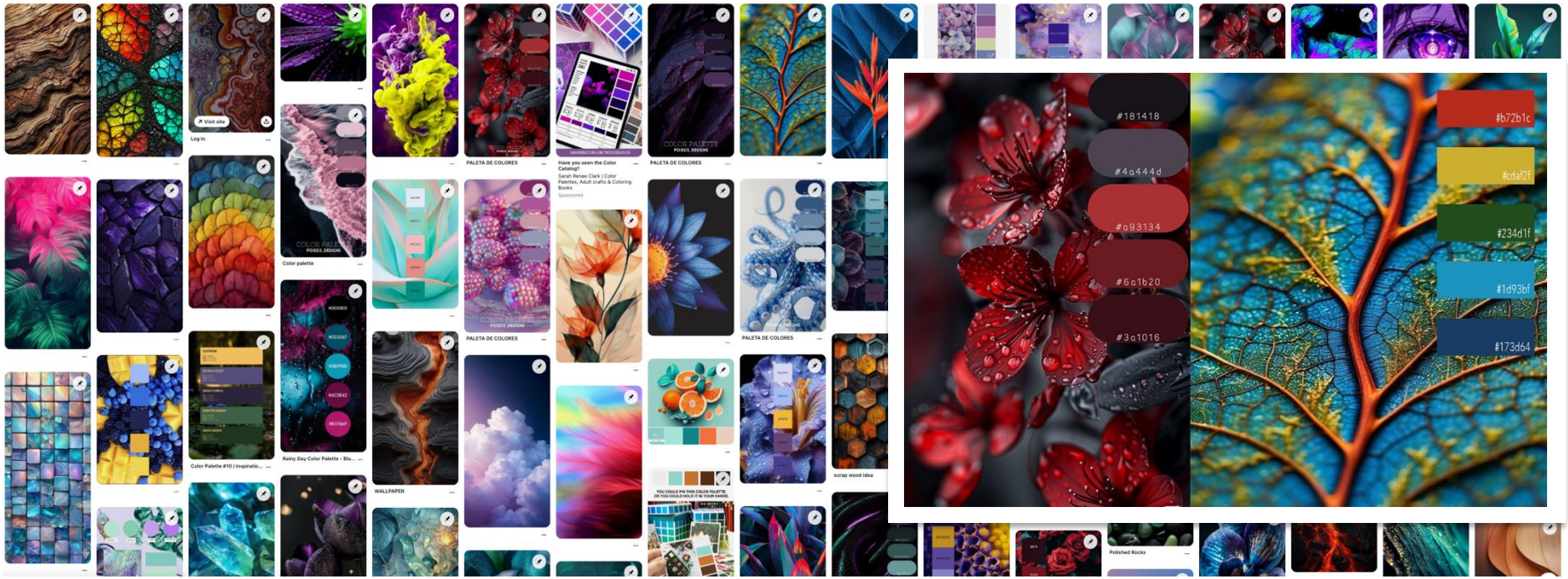
1 April 2025 - Week 7

Colors Day/Inspiration Board

A **Colors Inspiration Board** is a curated collection of color palettes that guide the visual tone and mood of a project. Its importance lies in helping artists and designers stay consistent with their aesthetic vision, explore emotional impact through color, and draw inspiration from nature, media, or existing works. It also serves as a visual reference when creating cohesive character designs, environments, or UI elements.



My early color choices were intuitive. Now I think about how color can communicate tone, mood, and character personality.

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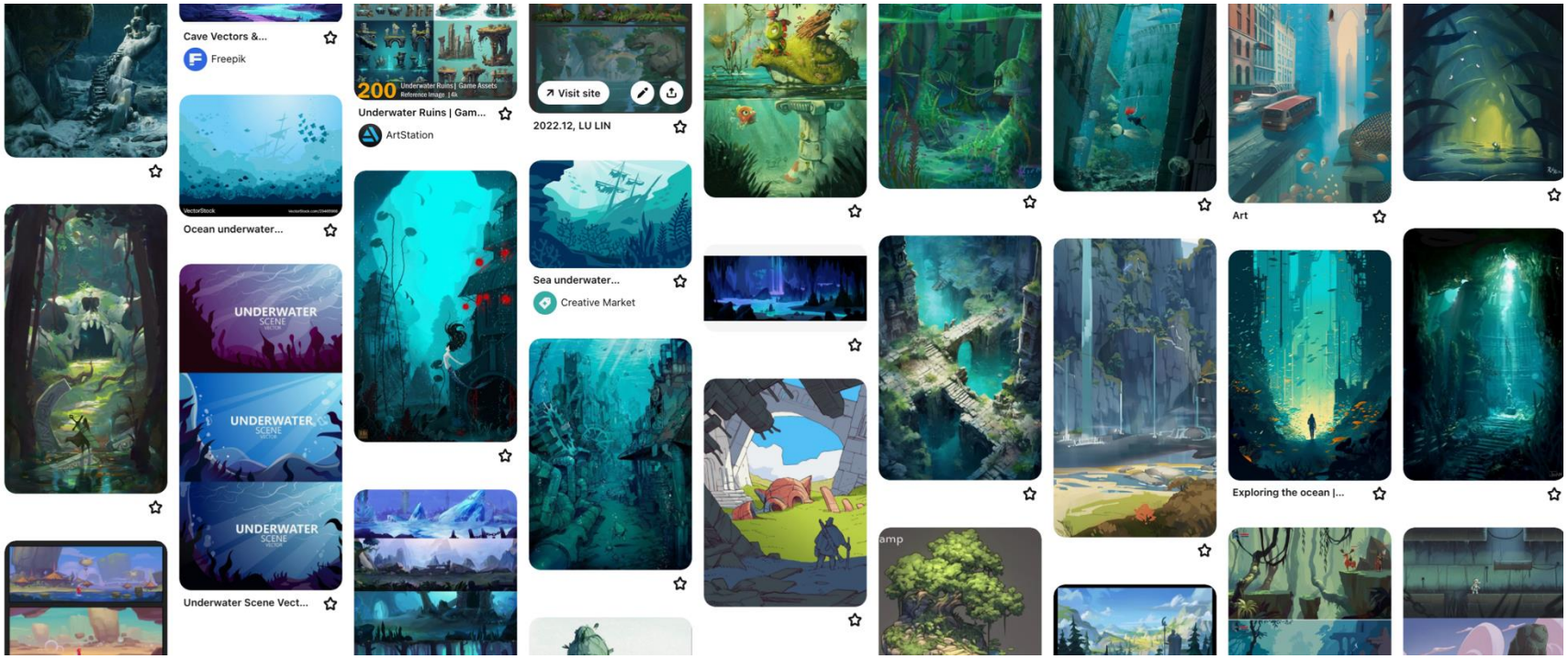
8 April 2025 - Week 8

Environment inspiration board

An **environment inspiration board** gathers visual references—such as landscapes, architecture, lighting, and textures—to guide the design of a setting or world. It's important because it helps establish mood, atmosphere, and context, ensuring the environment supports the narrative and style of the project. It also aids consistency and sparks creative ideas during the design process.



I went from just collecting cool images to understanding how space, light, and setting tell a story in a game world.

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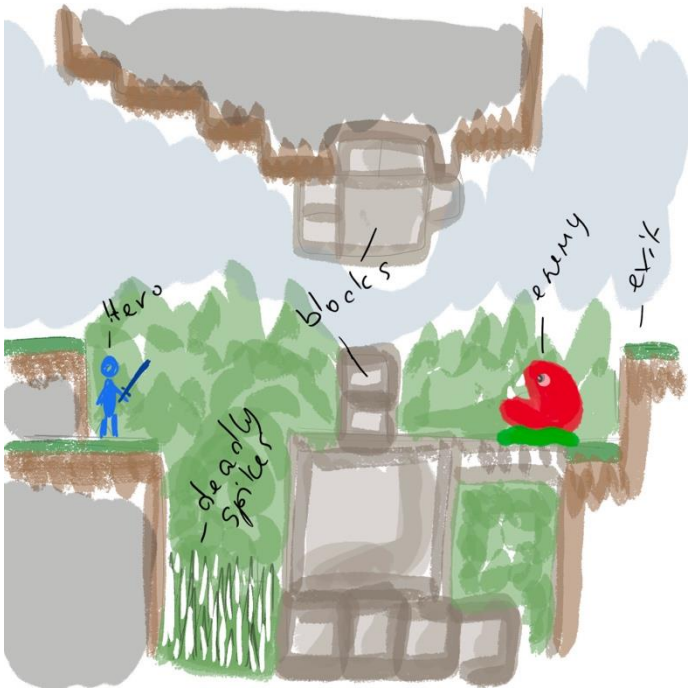
15 April 2025 - Week 9

Level Diagrams

Level diagrams are visual plans that map out the structure and flow of a game level. They are important because they help designers organize gameplay elements, define player paths, place obstacles and objectives, and balance pacing. By planning levels this way, teams can ensure clarity, consistency, and a smoother player experience before full production begins.



Initially, I treated it like a map. Later, I saw it as a player journey — about flow, emotion, and interaction.

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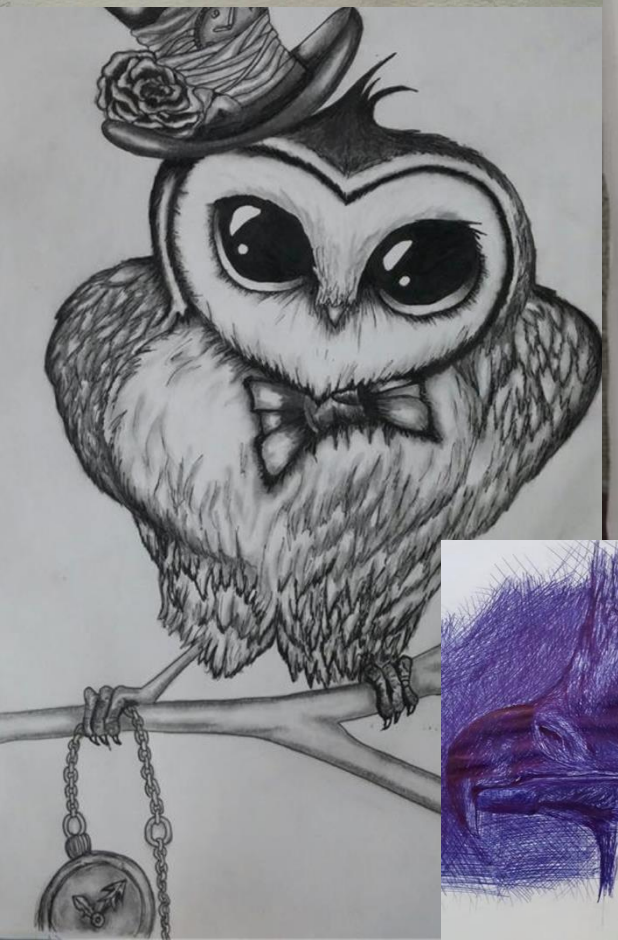
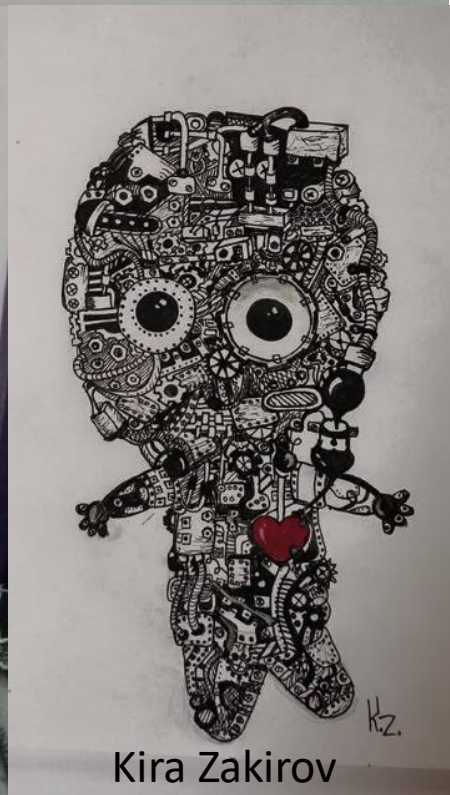
18 February 2025 - Week 10

A bit of my draws





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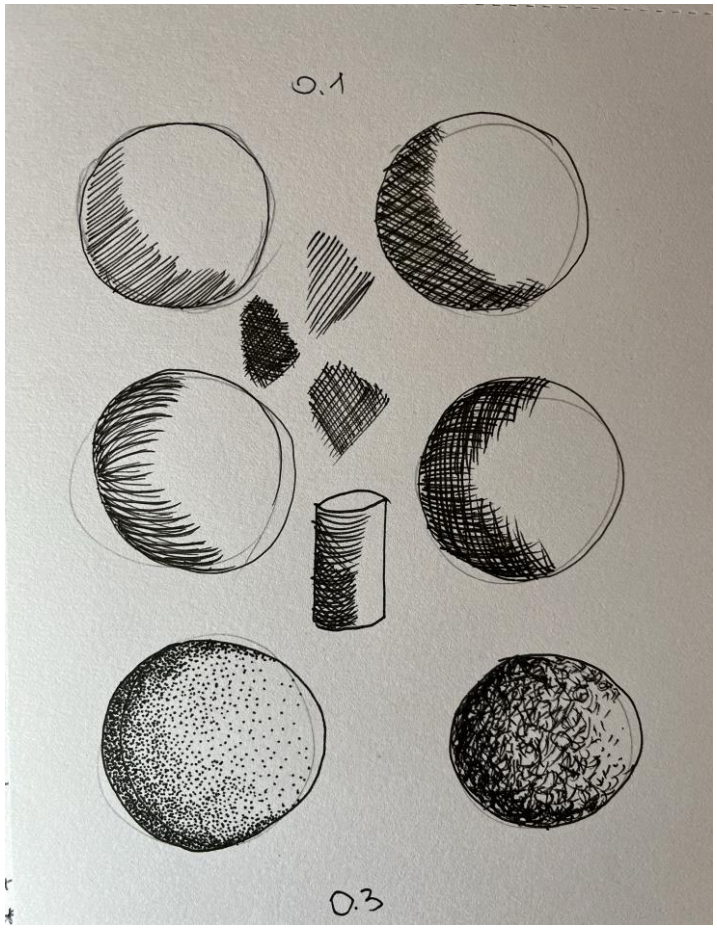
29 April 2025 - Week 11

Warm-up exercises



Warm-up exercises using different pen widths help artists explore how line weight can convey texture, movement, and depth. Using fine liners, brush pens, or markers with varied tips trains hand control, encourages dynamic line work, and prepares the artist for more intentional, expressive drawing. It’s a great way to loosen up and experiment with contrast and visual rhythm.

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Reflective review

Reflecting on both Assessment 1 and 2, I can clearly see how my creative thinking, technical skills, and storytelling have evolved. In **Assessment 1**, I focused on character design through the development of the *Axolotl Warrior*. Inspired by regenerative and underwater traits of axolotls, I combined fantasy, stealth, and cyber-ninja aesthetics to create a stylized and emotionally resonant character. This process helped me understand how anatomy, narrative, and silhouette contribute to a compelling game character. I developed a turnaround sheet, applied research into visual language, and began building a character that could anchor a larger game concept.

In **Assessment 2**, I shifted focus to environment design with *Shadow Post*, a meditative puzzle-platformer. I created visual references, developed a level layout, and explored environmental storytelling through light, architecture, and runic puzzles. This pushed me to think spatially, consider color symbolism, and support player navigation through mood and design elements. My skills in asset creation, sketching, and rendering have grown, and I better understand how to create immersive worlds that support gameplay and emotion.

Both projects helped clarify how characters and environments interact to create cohesive game worlds. I learned how to plan and iterate across different phases of design, and how visual research, experimentation, and storytelling combine to create assets with depth and meaning. These assessments deepened my understanding of 2D asset creation and solidified my interest in narrative-driven game development.